

duce high-speed Internet and free online teaching resources in every remote and rural school. After the US, many of the European nations have also implemented the same technique, followed by India, where now more than fifty per cent of schools, both public and private, have computers and other electronic gadgets, claims the Ministry of HRD.

The use of electronic gadgets is helping students and teachers in several ways. Learning and teaching via cool gadgets and technology are somewhat similar to watching your favourite movies, shows, or music videos. Using electronic gadgets in classrooms, such as iPods, smartboards, digital electronic devices, tablet PCs, etc, satisfies the growing standard of technology and prepares students for the future.

The major advantage is that technology/electronic gadgets assist students to develop their skill sets. Today, a majority of schools in India and around the world are technology-enabled. Teachers need to be well acquainted with new technologies so that they can use them properly in their teaching. Proper training sessions are now being given to teachers so that they can effectively use these sophisticated gadgets.

Another important aspect is that technology-based education helps students to think beyond their notebooks and improve their learning skills. Learning from tablet, PC and even smartphone is fun besides being quite easy and comfortable.

Ankit Shyamsukha, CEO, ICA Edu Skills, tells exclusively to EFY Media, "With accessible and affordable Internet, people are consuming content like never before. Even movies are being released online first. Doctors are being consulted over a 12.7cm (5-inch) mobile screen. Money is being earned and also spent online. Hence, it is logical that education/skilling is also going to see a sea change. From a hardware perspective, electronic products that provide portability and comfortability with a wider screen will always be high on demand, especially in short to medium-term range. This period shall see a huge uptick in the purchase of personal computers or laptops, tablets, etc. From a software perspective, anything that encourages guided or differential learning experiences will be high on priority. This pandemic has

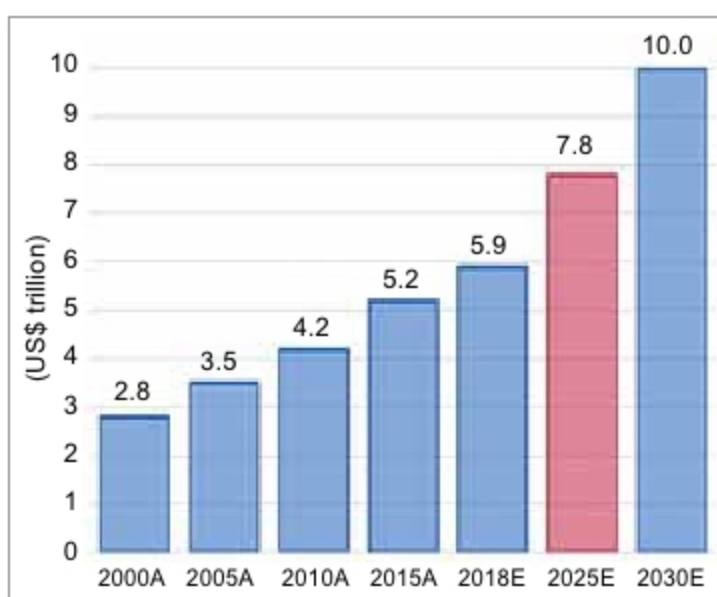


Fig. 2: Total global education expenditure (Source: HolonIQ, Smart Estimates, January 2019)

already shown how education should be our prime focus."

One of India's premier educational training institutes, ICA Edu Skills, states, "A lot of money has already been pumped into the edtech sector right from the beginning of this pandemic. Guided learning is going to take a lot of precedences now and in the future too. Home or private tuitions may see a disruption in the coming years. Guided learning platforms such as Vedantu and Byju's, which were considered as an 'add-on' to private coaching, shall now become mainstream. A lot of change will also happen at the test-preps industry online, and it will gain popularity over its offline and traditionally prominent classroom-based competitors. This change may be temporary or permanent, but online test prep is here to stay."

## Growth of technology/electronics in education globally

Even in 2017, technology had advanced so much that it helped the global education technology market to reach 17.7 billion dollars. It is expected to grow to 40.9 billion dollars by 2022, at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 18.3 per cent.

On the other hand, a report by MarketsandMarkets Research Private says that the global education technology market is expected to grow from 43.27 billion dollars in 2015 to 93.76 billion dollars this year, at a CAGR of 16.72 per cent.

The report also states that there are a number of new trends that are creating new opportunities for the education providers and learners so that

information can be effectively assessed by the end-users, including people with disabilities. Assistive and learning management solutions are enabling teachers to deliver special education in classrooms. The constant progression of technology in education has helped educators to create classrooms that are concrete, developed, collaborative, and conducted entirely through Web services.

The education industry is now spearheaded by high-speed Internet and top-notch electronic equipment valued at 76.4 billion dollars in 2019. The value is expected to grow at a CAGR of 18.1 per cent from 2020 to 2027.

According to Frost & Sullivan, education technology market growth is characterised by seismic shifts in technological demands and innovation, a solid movement towards virtual reality and augmented learning, and a user-centric product development strategy.

## Growth of technology based education in India

Globally, India is an important country in the field of education and has one of the highest clusters of sophisticated educational institutions. Also, it has immense potential to develop education systems further. In fact, the government has recently aimed to escalate its current gross ratio enrolment to thirty per cent by the end of this year, which would further galvanise the growth of distance education in the country.

The education sector in India was valued at 91.7 billion dollars in FY18 and was expected to reach 101.1 billion dollars in FY19, says research firm IBEF. India has become the second-largest market for e-learning after the US. The sector is expected to reach 1.96 billion dollars by 2021 with around 9.5 million users. The total amount of foreign direct investment (FDI) inflow into the education sector in India stood at 3.24 billion dollars from April 2000 to March 2020.

A couple of months back, the government of India launched PM eVIDYA, a programme for multi-mode access to digital/online education. Other initiatives to be launched in the coming years include Manodar-